



BUILDINGS 2025-010 BULLETIN O T C R

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PURPOSE: This Bulletin establishes acceptance criteria for **Adhesive-Based Solar Pedestal Bonding Systems** as an alternative material in the NYC Construction Codes.

SUBJECT(S): Solar Mounting System

RELATED LAWS & CODES: AC 28-113, BC 1604.1, BC 1708.2

I. BACKGROUND

Buildings, structures, and parts thereof must be designed and constructed in accordance with strength design, load and resistance factor design, allowable stress design, empirical design, or conventional construction methods, as outlined in Building Code, Section 1604.1. This bulletin specifically establishes criteria to determine the load profile of Adhesive-Based Solar Pedestal Bonding Systems to be used with BC 1604.1.

II. DESCRIPTION

An **Adhesive-Based Solar Pedestal Bonding System** is an alternative option for installing solar panels to roofs. Unlike conventional methods that require drilling holes and welding, which can potentially damage the roof, the Adhesive-Based Solar Pedestal Bonding System uses a structural adhesive to bond solar mounts to the roof surface. Solar photovoltaic panels will then be secured to the mounts.

III. USES

Adhesive-Based Solar Pedestal Bonding Systems support and secure solar panel mounts to roofing assemblies.

IV. EVALUATION SCOPE

NYC Construction Codes

V. EVALUATION CRITERIA

Pursuant to AC 28-113, the Office of Technical Certification and Research (OTCR) recognizes Adhesive-Based Solar Pedestal Bonding Systems when evaluated and designed in accordance with New York City Building Code Section 1708.2:

1708.2 Test standards. *Structural components and assemblies shall be tested in accordance with the appropriate material standards listed in Chapter 35. In the absence of a standard that contains an applicable load test procedure, the test procedure shall be developed by a registered design professional and approved.*

The test procedure shall simulate loads and conditions of application that the completed structure or portion thereof will be subjected to in normal use.

Until such a standard is created and adopted by DOB that contains applicable load procedures, the following shall be required:

- A registered design professional must establish a test procedure based on TAS 114-95, *Test Procedures for Roofing Assemblies in the High-Velocity Hurricane Zone Jurisdiction*, Appendix D Test Procedure for Simulated Uplift Pressure Resistance of Adhered Roofing Assemblies. Testing Application Standards (TAS) were developed for use in the High Velocity Hurricane Zone of Florida. TAS protocols are found in the test protocols section of the Florida Building code. OTCR has determined that the TAS should be used as the basis for an acceptable testing program.
- A modified TESTING APPLICATION STANDARD (TAS) 114-95, Appendix D must be used. Modifications to this standard are necessary as the unmodified standard is tailored to test static uplift resistance of roofing membranes. The standard requires adjustments to assess the strength of the recommended adhesives used to secure the mounting pedestal to the top of the roofing membrane. The standard should be revised to accommodate attachment of roof-mounted solar panels.
- Testing performed in accordance with the modified TESTING APPLICATION STANDARD (TAS) 114-95, Appendix D will be accepted. Considerations should be given to sections 7.2 and 7.4, other sections at the discretion of the registered design professional, and ASCE 7. Testing and use of the adhesive-based solar pedestal bonding system shall include specific conditions for the intended use. A qualified registered design professional must have 3 years of relevant experience in load testing.

VI. CONDITIONS OF ACCEPTANCE

Adhesive-based Solar Pedestal Bonding Systems shall comply with the NYC Construction Codes and the following applicable provisions:

- Filing.** A testing report based on the modified TAS 114-95 Appendix D shall be submitted as a construction document. The report shall document testing representative of the proposed on-site installation conditions and be available to support required inspections.
- Design.** Adhesive-based Solar Pedestal Bonding Systems shall be designed in accordance with the NYC Construction Codes, the conditions of the modified TAS 114-95 test, and the conditions of this Bulletin.
The design applicant must verify that the field conditions are consistent with the tested conditions to ensure compliance and proper performance.
- Installation Requirements.** Installation requirements shall be in accordance with the NYC Construction Codes, manufacturer's installation instructions, the results of the modified TAS test report, and the conditions of this Bulletin.
- Inspections.** Pursuant to section BC 1705.1.1, the installation of Adhesive-Based Solar Pedestal Bonding Systems shall be subject to special inspection requirements of Chapter 17 of the Building Code and Department Rules covering special inspection.

The design applicant is responsible for the following in DOB NOW:

- a) Identify Adhesive-Based Solar Pedestal Bonding Systems as a required special inspection.
- b) Certify that the special inspection agency engaged by the owner to supervise the Adhesive-Based Solar Pedestal Bonding Systems inspection is acceptable.

Special Inspectors of Adhesive-Based Solar Pedestal Bonding Systems shall:

- a) Maintain the same qualification requirements for the *Structural - Stability – Alterations to Existing Structures, Construction Operations Influencing Adjacent Structures, Mechanical Means and Methods of Demolition, Other Means of Demolition, and Raising and Moving of a Building* category as defined in 1 RCNY §101-06, Appendix A.
- b) Have duties and responsibilities in accordance with but not limited to 1RCNY §101-06 and BC §1704.1.1.2. The inspector shall verify that the field conditions are acceptable based on the requirements set by the design applicant, the conditions tested for in the submitted TAS test report, the approved drawings, and the conditions established in this *Bulletin* (see *Section VI. A of this Bulletin*). As part of such duties, the special inspection agency shall examine all approved construction documents relating to the work subject to special inspection to confirm that the documents are sufficient to enable proper performance of the inspection, and shall confirm that any shop drawings, submittals, or sketches have been accepted in writing by the registered design professional of record. All approved construction documents shall be maintained on site and be accessible to the special inspector at the time of inspection.; **and**
- c) Identify the responsibility for the special inspection of Adhesive-Based Solar Pedestal Bonding Systems and certify the completeness of all required inspection and testing activities in DOB NOW.